

Title(Still in Progress): The Burning Library

Logline: Unnamed wakes up in a burning library with no recollection of anything that has happened in the past few hours. The one fragment they remember is grabbing a book from a shelf.

Synopsis:

Unnamed wakes up, groggily and in pain. Something is constraining them and moving them. As their visions clear they realize its hands holding them up and dragging them. Looking to their side they see an unfamiliar person holding onto them. “Who-” the words barely come out as Unnamed tried to shrug the person off. The unfamiliar arms loosen and Unnamed falls onto the ground, wincing. Their ankle was twisted. Their eyes meet the concerned eyes of a stranger. The person looks at their leg and mentions that they are the librarian and helping her out by taking her to get medical aid in their office. Unnamed panics thinking this is all a trap and starts to slide away. The librarian stays in position and asks calmly for Unnamed to calm down for just a minute. Unnamed stays, eyes glued to the Librarian as they take out something from their trouser pocket. It's an ID card. The librarian tosses it to Unnamed. She grasps onto it and stares. The ID card is slightly burnt up due to the fire.

She stares at the details. Casper. The plastic covering his last name was charred. Librarian at the Library of Alexandria. Unnamed looked at the picture. It was him. Nodding, she offered the card back. He took it, placing it back in his pocket. Then, he pointed at the ankle. He says he has some important files he needs to retrieve from his office and there is a medical kit for the wounds. Unnamed starts to realize its not just a twisted ankle, but her forehead has a wound, and so does her arm. He has wrapped what appears to be a shirt around her hand. She touches her forehead. Its a tie stopping the bleeding. She asks what happened. The Librarian says Unnamed was at a shelf selecting a book when the fires began to envelope the area. Due to the suffocation, she collapsed and some of the books had collapsed on her ankle while she was unconscious. The Librarian again offers a hand. This time Unnamed takes it. Next scene is a dream that Unnamed faces after falling back into unconsciousness. Unnamed is in the library,

everything seems okay. Shes wandering through the aisles, happy. Then suddenly, a leather book catches her eye. She is reaching for it then....

She is being shaken awake. The librarian is yelling at her to wake up. He tells her one of the rebels that was part of the group that set the library on fire is near. She hears yells in the distance. She tries to glimpse who it is through the smoke. She sees a still blur and she cannot tell what they are yelling past those frantic comments the Librarian is making. Unnamed tries to move along with help of the librarian. They finally drag themselves to a staircase of the library. They had lost the rebel amongst the smoke. Now they had to climb to go to the floor where the office was. The Librarian begins to talk to make the process of climbing less uncomfortable for Unnamed. The Librarian talks about how his brother and him were complete opposites. How he was the more bookish one, who would spend his time learning as much as possible. His brother, however, believed he had a greater purpose and that books were not worth it. His brother eventually joined a cult and dissappeared, away from society and in a bubble of limited knowledge.

Eventually, they reach the top. There is still some more distance to cover. They take a break. The top floor is not too damaged, so it is not too suffocating. The Librarian realizes they are tired and asks Unnamed to make sure to keep watch while they take a break. The librarian dozes off against a shelf. Unnamed looks at the Librarian to make sure they are completely asleep. Then, she gets up. Her ankle is not twisted but she is weak. Oddly, she did not remember a bookshelf falling on her leg. She uses this time to escape. There is something off about the librarian, she cannot place it though. She dashes towards the stairs and runs down. Shes again faced by the fumes. She tries to meander them to get to the entrance of the building, but the library is large and fallen bookshelves provide obstacles for her. As she tries to make it through the aisles, she sees the blur from before. She makes her way to there this time. Her blood freezes when she sees it. A body slumped against a bookshelf in just an undershirt and trousers. Large wounds bleed through his upper body. She looked at his face and recognized him

immediately. The person she had been with this whole time had not been the librarian. The librarian was the guy in front of her. The person she had been with was Casper's twin, Charles. The one in the cult. Then it hit her. Whose shirt and tie had been tied to her wounds? It had been Casper's. She removes the shirt and tie and realizes the blood had never been hers. It had been Casper's. She merely had bumps from a fall. She suddenly feels something hit her head and everything turns black.

She is back on the shelf with the mystery book tucked away. She is reaching for it... and then she hears someone clearing their throat behind her. She turns and sees her assistant with someone. That someone is Casper. Assistant leaves Casper and Unnamed to talk. Casper introduces himself as the new Librarian and thanks her for the job. Unnamed is revealed to be at her office on the top floor of this library and welcomes Casper as a new employee.

Unnamed wakes up and sees herself tied up again with the same tie and shirt against her chair. She looks up to see Charles staring at her and sitting on her desk. Charles then refers to her with her name Athena Oakhall. Charles then grins, deciding to narrate his purpose. He talks about how he is part of the group Antiknow, that believed that the world would come to an end if too much knowledge was discovered, and that people must be limited to the knowledge of survival like in primitive times. He said that his purpose had been given to him by his leader The Golden One. The Golden One had blessed him with the quest to burn the symbol of knowledge, the Library of Alexandria. However, not only was the burning of knowledge needed but also the provider. Charles points with his knife at Athena. Athena is the owner of the library. Charles continues to say that a sacrifice was needed to fulfill his quest. He turns slightly away, and Athena takes this opportunity. She picks up her chair hastily and tries twist away, so the chair hits him. Her legs were only loosely tied together so it was easy for her to twist. Before anything happens, he grabs the chair, manages to push her down and smacks her head with a heavy book. She goes unconscious.

Shes back to the memory of her talking to Casper. She offers a tour, but Casper says it's not necessary. Athena is determined to show him around and goes out of the office. She heads says that its best to tour the bottom floor first then come back to the top, so he understands the order of things. She heads to the top of the stairs and freezes. Through the gaps she sees her bookshelves on fire. She feels a wack against her head and her body begins to fall down the stairs until aSmack!

Charles is slapping her awake. Shes know completely tied. What about her assistant, how was she, she asks Charles. Charles then says that the assistant was part of the Antiknow. Then Athena asks why Charles has kept her alive if she was meant for sacrifice. He proceeds to tell her it's a primitive need for objects of survival, which meant in this society that was wealth. Charles continued to say he had found out from The Golden One that Athena had a safe in her office and for her to offer up all the wealth in it. Charles dug the knife under her chin. Athena nodded. She looked out of the window again. Smoke everywhere. Soon the building would collapse. She would be lost in the rubble.

She tells him to loosen one hand at least to help him. He is hesitant before loosening it. He grips onto her wrist telling her 'no funny business'. She looks over at the shelf behind her, Charles twisting her chair to face it. Her eyes wandered to find the leather book. She's scanning and then her eyes drop to it. She takes the book out of the shelf with her free hand. Suddenly, a crack is heard and the rug next to her desk lifts to reveal a trapdoor. She urges Charles to go. Charles opens and enters. As soon as he dissappears into the floor, Athena turns and places the book back into the shelf with a click. The trapdoor shuts hard. Next it shows that the trapdoor simply leads to the first floor, which is consumed with fire. Charles has no way to escape. Athena manages to use her free hand to untie herself. Then, she goes over to the window to peer out. She smiles at her secret use of trapdoor.